

Donald Richardson

Expert leadership in modern technology systems

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SUMMARY

Technical leader with over 20+ years of industry experience and 7+ years of leadership experience. Dedicated to the craft of the art of the possible, combining critical business thinking, empathetic communication, and deep technical expertise. Committed to being a foundational partner and team-member in a growth-driven, forward-thinking company.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Innovation Director

House of Apex 08/2025 - Present Remote

- Drive AI adoption strategy and automation across design and content production pipelines
- Architect and build AI-powered tools leveraging LLMs and diffusion models for client deliverables and internal operations
- Develop workflow automation systems for proposal generation and production delivery
- Build web-based prototypes and internal tooling to accelerate company-wide efficiency

Platform Technology Director

Gensler 10/2021 - 03/2023 New York, New York - Remote

- Responsible for technical research, synthesis and analysis for core software product
- Represented technical expertise for short-, mid-, and long-term business goals and product go-to-market strategy
- Established software development standards, technology ecosystem, and pipeline from the ground-up to build a new team and capability within the company
- Defined and documented a robust software development lifecycle (SDLC)
- Detailed definition of system architecture and delineation of product requirements and user stories
- Responsible for security, privacy, and compliance requirements

Creative Technology Director, New York Studio

Gensler 07/2018 - 10/2021 New York, New York

- Responsible for managing the technical aspects of digital experience projects from inception to production to sustainment
- Responsible for technical project management including planning, budgeting, stakeholder communication, team building, and team management
- Responsible for software architecture, information architecture, data modeling, and the development of critical or high-touch components for project work
- Led or significantly contributed to dozens of projects, many for Fortune 500 clients, totalling in 35M+ of revenue
- Worked closely and created strategic partnerships with external parties and vendors
- Grew and mentored and team members

System Architect & Engineer

C&G Partners LLC 07/2017 - 07/2018 New York, New York

- System architecture for a large-scale project for a cultural institution in DC
- Establishment of information architecture & data model for over a dozen interactive experiences
- Implementation of backend including headless CMS content distribution functionality, 3rd party data aggregation, management & moderation of user generated content, and more
- Implementation of devops functionality including CI/CD, software deployment, & configuration management

Digital Experience Developer

Red Paper Heart 03/2017 - 07/2017 New York, New York

- Creation of a tennis swing tracking system for an interactive game for Samsung
- Web-based tablet experience for an interactive experience for an event sponsored by Ford Motors

Technical Consultant

Art Institute of Chicago 10/2016 - 03/2017 New York, New York - Remote

- Stakeholder research & requirements synthesis for website modernization
- In-depth technical audit of relevant internal systems
- Proposal of a modernized technical architecture to allow for better integration of components, better scalability & modularity
- Plan & documentation for implementation of modernized system

SKILLS

Management Skills

Visioning & Alignment

Stakeholder Communication Agile / Lean

Budgeting & Forecasting Team Building

Go-to-market Strategy

Product Ownership & Management

Project Management

Process Definition & Standards

Technical Skills

System Architecture

Documentation & Diagramming

DevOps Pipeline

Security/Privacy/Compliance

Agile Development Infrastructure / IaC

Cloud Software Development Testing

SDLC Hardware Specification

Front-end Web Technologies

Typescript ESNext Webpack Vite

HTML CSS Sass/Less Tailwind

React Redux Recoil SSR

Accessibility Security WebGL

Three.JS Electron

Other Front-end Technologies

TouchDesigner Cinder

OpenFrameworks OpenGL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Director, New York Studio

Second Story Interactive Studios 10/2015 - 10/2016 New York, New York

- Put in place technical process, standard architecture, & coding conventions for software development throughout the lifetime of the project
- Established strategic relationships with vendors & partners
- Responsible for technical hiring & resourcing

Technical Lead

Second Story Interactive Studios 10/2013 - 10/2015 Portland, Oregon

- Managed the technical aspects of numerous industry-leading and award-winning projects on-budget and on-time

Full-stack Developer / Interactive Developer / Sr. Interactive Developer

Second Story Interactive Studios 08/2009 - 10/2013 Portland, Oregon

- Software architecture and development from backend and devops systems to web, mobile, desktop, and high-performance OpenGL applications

Full-stack Developer

Full-time roles at multiple companies 2003 - 2009 Portland Oregon

- Web application development
- UI/UX feasibility analysis
- Feature prioritization
- Bug fixes
- Change management
- E-commerce
- Prototyping

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Mathematics

Portland State University

2000 - 2006 Portland, Oregon

SKILLS

DevOps

IaC	Terraform	Pulumi	
Configuration Management		Puppet	
SaltStack	SCM	Git	Subversion
CI/CD	Github Actions	Observability	
New Relic		Feature Flags	
Artifact Repository		Nexus	
Documentation		C4	Atlassian

Back-end Technologies

Python	C#	C++	Typescript
Node.js	Cloud	Serverless	AWS
SQL	PostgresQL	MySQL	
Stored Procedures		NoSQL	MongoDB
REST	Swagger	GraphQL	Apollo
Testing	Jest	Cypress.io	Cucumber
Messaging		RabbitMQ	Django
Express/Koa		Docker	

AWS Technologies

Lambda	EC2	S3	VPC	API Gateway
Cloudfront		DynamoDB		AmazonMQ
SNS	SQS	Route53	Load Balancing	
IAM	Cognito			

Other

IoT	Arduino	Raspberry PI
Depth Sensors		